

This short text, known as the Dhāraṇī of Liberation from Bondage (in Tibetan, li

Toh 796 · Derge Kangyur

This short text, known as the Dhāraṇī of Liberation from Bondage (in Tibetan, likely titled something close to Bcings pa las grol ba'i gzungs), belongs to the dhāraṇī class of Buddhist literature found within the Kangyur as Toh 796. Framed as an act of homage to the bodhisattva of compassion, noble Avalokiteśvara, it consists of a mantra—invoking Tārā and calling upon the "liberator from bondage"—together with a brief statement of its purpose and power. The text explains that the recitation of this sacred formula frees the practitioner from bondage, suggesting both literal and spiritual dimensions of captivity and release. As a dhāraṇī, it exemplifies the genre of protective and liberating incantations preserved in the canon, meant for ritual recitation rather than doctrinal exposition.

Homage to noble Avalokiteśvara.

Tāre tāre tārāya, bhagavate, bandhamocani, hāhā.

If this noble mantra is recited aloud, it liberates one from bondage.

The Dhāraṇī of Liberation from Bondage—

Translator's Notes

- The mantra syllables (tāre tāre tārāya, bhagavate, bandhamocani hāhā) are left in transliterated Sanskrit, as is standard practice for mantras rather than translating them. The final line appears to be the opening of a dhāraṇī's title, continuing into a following passage not included here.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.